

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an introduction by a local museum to accompany an exhibition:

The decline of Cantopop?

Since the 1950s, Cantonese Pop music (or Cantopop) has been at the centre of popular culture in Hong Kong. It has been the fruit of the hard work of countless singers. We grew up with Cantopop. It is our collective memory.

However, concerns have recently been voiced by industry experts that the impact of Cantopop is fading from Hong Kong's popular culture.

The emergence of new media such as mobile phones and the Internet has both allowed music from abroad to flood Hong Kong and encouraged the illegal downloading of music. These damaging activities have forced down music sales from HK\$17 billion in 2002 to HK\$0.56 billion in 2012.

Meanwhile, the entertainment industries of neighboring regions have made great advances since the 1980s, and singers from the Mainland and Taiwan have grown in popularity. K-Pop and J-Pop (from Korea and Japan) are also massively popular. This means Cantopop is now less dominant in Asia.

Finally, it has often been said that Cantopop content has been over-focused towards love songs for young people. Unlike in the 1970s-1990s, this limited range is failing to attract a diverse audience and so is ignoring older generations. Is Cantopop destined to disappear in the next generation?

Your group wants to propose a project focusing on Cantopop for the *Learning English through Popular Culture* elective at school. You may want to talk about:

- why Cantopop is a suitable topic for the school project
- what to include in the proposal
- whether you agree with the article that Cantopop is less popular today
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Who is your favourite Cantopop star in Hong Kong?
2. Do you enjoy singing Cantopop in karaoke?
3. Do you listen to Cantopop?
4. What do you like about Cantopop?
5. Would you like to be a Cantopop star?
6. Why do you think K-Pop and J-Pop are so popular in Hong Kong?
7. Do you think people should be able to share songs on the Internet for free?
8. Do you think the subjects in Cantopop songs are relevant to young people's lives in Hong Kong?